Trust Thamesmead

contact

Issue 5 THE NEWSLETTER OF TRUST THAMESMEAD Summer 2004

Trust Thamesmead appoints new chief executive



• Mick Hayes - joining the Thamemead success story

Trust Thamesmead has appointed Mick Hayes as its new chief executive.

Mick, who joins from The Forum @ Greenwich (an organisation with a similar role to the Trust), succeeds the late Roland Ashley and takes over from John Alderson who has been acting chief executive since Roland's death at the end of last year. Trust Thamesmead chair Jackie Smith says: "We are delighted to have recruited someone of Mick's calibre to lead our team at a time when Thamesmead is set to play a pivotal role in the Thames Gateway success story. I would also like to take the opportunity to thank John Alderson for holding the fort during an upsetting time and a period of change for our staff."

• There will be an interview with Mick in the next issue of Contact.

Community Chest proves a huge success

Trust Thamesmead's Community Chest scheme has proved a huge success with the local community.

The funding programme, which has recently been completed, saw 120 groups benefit from financial assistance with projects from all sections of the community able to access financial support to help develop their work. The scheme was designed to encourage groups to get into the habit of applying for funding to encourage the long term sustainability of their activities and to take a more proactive approach to accessing the financial support available.

Among the projects able to further their work as a result of the Community Chest are Headway – the brain injury rehabilitation centre – which has created a new arts and crafts room; the Red Rovers Football Club which used the money to provide better training and improve player facilities, and the Fathers Arms Project – a scheme that supports the rehabilitation of ex-offenders and helps them integrate back into the community.

Rav Jheeta, Trust Thamesmead's community development worker, says: "As a result of the Community Chest hundreds of local people have benefited from improved services, facilities and access to support, advice and information. This scheme has helped encourage more volunteers, enabled groups to work in line with Charity Commission guidelines and empowered the community to take an active role in funding and development."

• Scoring funding success: members of the red Red Rovers Football Club



Trust Thamesmead launches website

The new Trust Thamesmead website is now up and running. It has been initially designed to support the Trust's work and to provide back-up to people looking for additional information on its wide ranging community programme.

In the longer term it is hoped to develop the site to a position where it can be accessed for a more pro-active use of community service marketing as well as providing a platform for consultation with local people and seeking feedback on Trust activities.

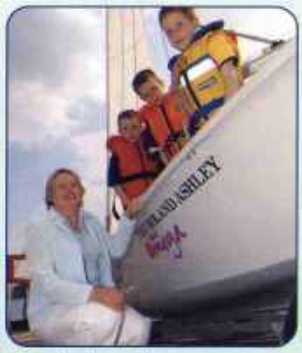
Through its support of the Government's UK Online programme, Trust Thamesmead is trying to ensure that as many local people as possible have access to the internet and email. You can read more about UK Online later in this issue.

The Trust Thamesmead website can be visited at www.trustthamesmead.co.uk

Thamesmead sailing centre honours Roland Ashley

Trust Thamesmead's late chief executive Roland Ashley has been honoured by the Thamesmead YMCA RYA (Royal Yachting Association) Sailing Centre.

A new dinghy bearing Roland's name was officially launched in May and took to Southmere Lake alongside a flotilla of other sailing vessels with local young people at the helm.



• Claire Ashley with young members of the Thamesmead YMCA Sailing Centre

George Reynolds of the Thamesmead YMCA RYA Sailing Centre says: "Roland was a keen sailor and showed an immediate interest in our work from the moment he arrived at the Trust. We are delighted to have raised over £4500 to christen and launch this new dinghy in his name. We will remember Roland as someone always ready to roll up his sleeves to get the job done and we hope he would be proud to have his name so closely associated with our work."

The Roland Ashley Memorial Dinghy was officially launched by Roland's widow Claire in a ceremony also attended by the Mayors of Greenwich and Bexley.

Dawn receives recognition of civic commitment

Dawn Snape is celebrating success after being recognised in Bexley Council's annual civic recognition awards.

The 16 year old from Erith received her prize in the young person's category for her voluntary work with the Thamesmead YMCA Royal Association Sail Training Centre.



• Honouring civic commitment: Dawn Snape with Bexley Mayor, Councillor Denis Daniels

Dawn has worked with the centre for the past seven years and for the past four has given help and training to other members on a regular basis. She was recognised for consistently enthusing young people - especially those under the age of 12 - and inspiring them to achieve the Royal Yachting Association's sailing certificate.

Bexley Mayor, Councillor Denis Daniels, said: "It is a great tribute to the people of Bexley that the standard of nominations this year was once again of an exceptional quality. I would like to thank and congratulate Dawn and all those involved for their selfless voluntary service to the community."

Looking for funding?

Three grant funding programmes in the Greenwich and Bexley boroughs are now available to groups in the local community with an income of less than £50,000 a year. Local Network fund - below £100,000.

Operated by the South East London Community Programme (SELF) the schemes are the Local Network Fund for children and young people offering grants of up to £7,000; the Community Learning Chest with funding of up to £2,000 for training and development, and the Neighbourhood Renewal Community Chest which is offering grants of up to £5,000 to help increase involvement in community activities.

The last two schemes are available to groups based in the Greenwich borough only. For further information, full details of the application process and deadline dates call SELF on 020 7582 5117 or visit www.selcf.com

A workshop held in partnership with SELF will run on Wednesday 7th July, 1 – 3pm. Call Ravinder to book a place on 020 8320 4470.

Serving up recruitment success with Brewers Fayre

Trust Thamesmead joined forces with Brewers Fayre recently to fill a range of vacancies at the family pub chain's new Thamesmead restaurant.

Working with Job Centre Plus, Trust offices were used to host a recruitment forum in early April. Almost 200 applicants came through the doors during the course of the day and an impressive 83 candidates made it through to a second interview.

Representatives from Brewers Fayre - which has run more than 40 recruitment days across the UK - praised Trust Thamesmead's support and said this was one of their most successful events of this kind to date.

Dawn Young, Trust Thamesmead's acting head of regeneration, says: "We have a long history of working with employers to help fill vacancies and bring a range of new and existing job opportunities to the attention of our community.



Brewers Fayre will not only be a wonderful addition to the leisure scene in Thamesmead, it will also become a valuable source of local employment in an area which is benefiting from more and more exciting opportunities."

Keeley Savill joins Trust board

Keeley Savill has joined the Trust Thamesmead board.



A local resident for 14 years, Keeley has been actively involved in the community having previously served on the boards of Thamesmead Town and Gallions Housing Association. She also has first hand experience of the work of Trust Thamesmead having received training that enabled her to return to work following a career break.

Keeley says: "I believe that in order to make changes you have to get involved in your community and I am delighted to be able to contribute to the work of Trust Thamesmead. As the mother of a seven year old son one of my main priorities will be to try and ensure the Trust continues its excellent work with our young people."

Climbing wall heading for success with improved facilities

A number of improvements have been made to the facilities at the Thamesmead Climbing Wall.



Launched last September, the attraction is already proving to be a big success with the local community. Two new toilet blocks have been built, heating has been installed and an enclosed area for spectators has been created.

The centre is now open from 1.30 to 6.00 pm every day and until 9.00 pm on Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday. Among the new activities are sponsored climbs, half day introductory sessions and film making opportunities. The facility is also playing host to corporate days by offering challenge and team building events.

For further information call Ann on 020 8320 4494 or June on 020 8320 4470.

Getting the UK Online

For most of us the internet and email are an integral part of daily life, but for those without access to a computer and the necessary training it can feel as if they are being left behind in today's information-driven world.

That is why Trust Thamesmead has, for over a year, been playing an active role in UK Online - a Government-backed initiative to ensure everyone has access to new technology.

If you are interested in travelling into cyberspace, we can help with free training and by getting you started with an email address and tips on using the internet for your job, interest or hobby.

The service is available at Limestone Community Hall between 10.00 am and 4.00 pm Monday to Friday. For further information call Dave Ryan on 020 8312 1892.

UK Online is provided locally by Trust Thamesmead in a partnership with Community Network Training.

Easter bonnet celebrations at Evenlode

Senior members of the local community celebrated Easter in style at Evenlode Pop-In Parlour in Caroline Walk.



An Easter Bonnet Day came complete with a lunch and music from a talented three-piece band. The competition was judged by the Mayor of Bexley, Councillor Denis Daniels and Trust Thamesmead's acting head of regeneration Dawn Young. The eight winners – who all attend the regular senior citizen club at Evenlode – received Easter eggs as prizes.

Action team on hand for job seekers

As if job interviews weren't stressful enough there is a whole list of things to worry about before you even get to that all-important opportunity - what to wear?, what makes the most impressive c.v.? and what to do with the little one while you're busy selling yourself to a future employer?

The Greenwich Action Team for Jobs is now on hand to help the unemployed or those returning to work with advice on everything from general tips and advice to guidance on your wardrobe, assistance with travel expenses and help with registered childcare.

The service is available every Thursday between 10.00 am and 4.00 pm at the Trust Thamesmead offices. To make an appointment call 020 8320 4470.

Panto in April - oh yes it is!

Children at St Margaret Clitherow Primary School in Thamesmead were able to practice their hiss and boo skills recently with a highly enjoyable production of pantomime favourite Aladdin.



Trust Thamesmead's community involvement team organised the event after asking local schools to write in saying why they felt theirs should be the venue for some unseasonal panto fun.

St Margaret Clitherow in Cole Close was selected for its recent very successful Ofsted report and for the consistently hard work of both pupils and staff.

YOUR COLUMN

Greenwich & Bexley Cottage Hospice



The UK hospice movement is a remarkable achievement. These specialist centres for the care of the terminally ill rely heavily on community volunteers to fund their work and manage vital services that are essential to both patients and their families.

Situated within Bostall Woods, the Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice is a registered charity and makes no charge for the care and support it offers.

The centre's in-patient Woodlands unit has 19 beds for respite care, pain and symptom control and terminal care, while the Shornells day care centre is a vibrant facility on weekdays with various counselling support services on offer to patients and their relatives.

Jim Bennett of the Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice says: "Volunteers play a vital part in the life of the hospice through everything from counselling, housekeeping and driving vehicles to gardening, fundraising, retail and complimentary therapies.

"This year the hospice celebrates 10 years of care and service to the local community. We would like to thank everyone who supports us and to invite anyone who feels they would like to contribute to our work to contact us."

If you would like to support the hospice by volunteering or making a donation contact Jim Bennett on 020 8312 2244, email appeals@gbch.org.uk or visit www.cottagehospice.org.uk

If you would like to see your organisation featured in Contact, please write to Dawn Aarons, Contact, Trust Thamesmead, 19A Joyce Dawson Way, Thamesmead Town Centre, London SE28 8RA. You call also call Dawn on 020 8320 4474 or email her at daarons@trust-thamesmead.co.uk

Meet The Team

Rav Jheeta – Community Development Worker



Rav Jheeta is Trust Thamesmead's first point of contact for community groups needing advice, guidance and support in setting up projects and looking to access funding. If an event is taking place and you need a smiling face behind a camera, Rav's your girl!

Q. Age?
A. 25
Q. How long have you worked for Trust Thamesmead?
A. Since August 2003
Q. Favourite food?
A. Thai
Q. Favourite singer?
A. Alicia Keys
Q. Favourite film star?
A. John Travolta
Q. Favourite colour?
A. Purple
Q. Favourite pastime?
A. Travelling

In Rav's own words:
My job is very rewarding as it not only allows me to help the local community but also to meet and work with a diverse range of people and groups and – hopefully – help to make a difference in the area in which I live.

Budding Beckhams wanted

The Red Rovers Football Club is looking for new players in the under 13 and under 15 age categories. Training takes place every Saturday morning at Birchmere Park.

For further details call Suzanne on 07944 462 815.

Summer holiday with Roving Street Scheme

Trust Thamesmead's popular Roving Street Scheme (RSS) is back for six weeks of summer holiday fun from July 26.

The action-packed programme of sports and activities takes place at three different venues across Thamesmead and Abbey Wood on weekday afternoons until September 3.

All RSS staff are qualified in childcare and first aid, activities are free and parents and carers are welcome to stay and join in the fun. The under eights must be accompanied by an adult for all Roving Street Scheme activities.

For further information call Trevor Cross on 020 8320 4477 or visit www.trustthamesmead.co.uk

Diary of events

DATE	*EVENT/ACTIVITY*
Daily	Thamesmead Climbing Wall For opening times, prices and bookings call Anne at Trust Thamesmead on 020 8320 4494.
Wednesdays 6.15 to 7.45pm	Charlton Athletic Community Football Scheme for the 8-10 and 11-16 age groups Hawksmoor Youth Club, Bentham Road, Central Thamesmead - **Girls Only**
2nd July, 6th August and 3rd September	JFC (Junior Funky City) Monthly disco for the 11-13 age group at Thamesmere Leisure Centre Drug Free Zone Call Trevor Cross on 020 8320 4477/0776 761 3273 for dates and times.
Wed 4th August	Trust Family Fun day at Southmere Park.

Trust Thamesmead's wide-ranging programme of work is funded by:

London Development Agency · New Opportunities Fund Lottery Funded · Abbey Wood Thamesmead Partnership · Sure Start · UK online centres

Trust Thamesmead

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If you have any comments on Contact - or would like to make a suggestion regarding future content – please write to: Contact, Trust Thamesmead, 19A Joyce Dawson Way, Thamesmead Town Centre, London SE28 8RA.